COVER STORY

IT LAYOFFS

WHO MOVED MY JOB?

INDIA'S BIGGEST EMPLOYMENT GENERATOR SEES MASSIVE RETRENCHMENT, FORCING COMPANIES IN THE SECTOR TO RESTRUCTURE OR RISK OBSOLESCENCE

By **M.G. ARUN & AJAY SUKUMARAN**

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**

7.3 million
No. of people employed in India's IT sector

72 per cent
Drop in new hirings in top six IT firms in Q1FY26 over the preceding quarter

50 per cent
Drop in big tech entry-level hirings from pre-COVID levels